

Welcome to Advanced English

Welcome, and thank you for joining us. You already use English confidently at work, in your studies, and in daily life. This course is about the next layer: precision, nuance, and control. You'll learn to say exactly what you mean, with the right degree of certainty; to write essays, reports, and professional emails that readers take seriously; to read arguments critically; and to hold your own in a seminar or a meeting, choosing your register as deliberately as your words.

Some of you have just finished our B2 class, and some of you are joining us for the first time, often with years of professional experience behind you. That range of experience is one of this class's greatest resources. Everyone is welcome here.

WHEN AND WHERE

 Days:

 Time:

 Place / Room:

 First class:

 Last class:

 The course runs for **13 weeks**, with **2 classes** a week. Each class lasts **90 minutes**, so there are **26 classes** in total.

 **Class 12** is a halfway review project, and **Class 13** is a short progress check, so you know exactly what to refine in the second half. In **Class 25** you'll present and defend a short position paper, and in **Class 26** there's a final check, including a one-to-one conversation with your teacher, followed by a celebration and **certificates**. 

WHAT TO BRING



a notebook



a pen or pencil



your phone
(if you have one)



water
(if you like)

 Your teacher will give you a **workbook**. Please bring it to **every** class. We also recommend keeping a **personal phrasebook**: a small notebook, or a note on your phone, for collocations, fixed phrases, and dependent prepositions you want to own. At C1, a well-kept phrasebook is worth more than any vocabulary list.

HOW OUR CLASS WORKS



Please arrive **on time**. Every class starts with a speaking warm-up that recycles the last class.



Keep your phone **on silent**. We use phones only for class activities.



At C1, feedback covers three things: **accuracy** (is it correct?), **range** (is there a more precise choice?), and **appropriacy** (does it suit the reader and the situation?). All three are worth hearing.



Take risks with new language. Your teacher will note errors and come back to them later, so try the new structure even if you're not sure of it yet.



If you can't come, please **let your teacher know**, and do the online lesson at home.



Your personal story is **yours**. When a task asks about your life, you can always use a real or an imagined example.

HOW WE RUN SEMINARS AND DISCUSSIONS

Much of this course happens in discussion: seminars, debates, and a position-paper defense at the end. These ground rules keep them rigorous *and* respectful:



Listen to the end, then build on what was said: "Building on Ana's point..."



Challenge the idea, not the person. "I'd question that assumption," never "That's ridiculous."



Acknowledge, soften, then challenge. "I take your point, but I'm not sure the evidence supports it."



Share the floor. If you've spoken a lot, hand over by name: "What's your view, Tomás?"



Assigned sides are normal. You may argue a position you don't hold. It's excellent practice, and nobody has to reveal a personal view.



Some topics stay outside. We argue about work, study, technology, health, and community life, not party politics or religion.

HOW WE GIVE PEER FEEDBACK ON WRITING

In our **writing labs** you'll often read a classmate's draft, and they'll read yours. Good peer review makes both writers better:



Start with a genuine strength, and be specific: "Your thesis is clear by the second sentence."



Ask questions rather than issue verdicts. "What's the evidence for this claim?" works better than "This is wrong."



Big picture first, then detail. Comment on structure and argument before grammar and spelling.



Two suggestions are enough. Choose the two changes that would improve the text most.



Comment on the writing, not the writer. "This paragraph could be tighter," not "You always write too much."



Receive feedback graciously. Say thank you, ask for clarification if you need it, and decide later which suggestions to use.

USEFUL PHRASES FOR CLASS

WHEN YOU NEED CLARIFICATION

 Could you clarify what you mean by ___?

 Is there a difference in nuance between ___ and ___?

 Would ___ be appropriate in a formal report?

 So if I understand you correctly, ...?

IN A SEMINAR OR DISCUSSION

 Could I just come in here?

 I take your point, but ...

 Building on what you said, ...

 So where does that leave us?

IN PEER REVIEW

 What works particularly well here is ...

 Have you considered ...?

Advanced English (C1): free

Every class has a matching **online lesson** with the same grammar, vocabulary, model texts, and dialogues. It's your homework, and it lets you catch up if you miss a class. It works on a phone, a tablet, or a computer.

[`rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/`](https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/)

- 1 Open the website, or scan the QR code with your phone camera.

- 2 Choose the lesson your teacher gives you (for example, **Lesson 2.2**).
- 3 Press the  buttons to hear the model sentences, dialogues, and talks. Then **shadow** them: say each line along with the audio, copying its stress, rhythm, and intonation. (No sound? Turn up the volume, or try the Chrome browser. The  Audio control lets you choose a US or UK voice and slow it down.)
- 4 Do the exercises and the quiz, then the lesson project. Record your spoken projects, listen back, and write one thing to refine in your learning journal.

 Aim for **40–60 minutes, 2–3 times** a week, plus a little reading in English every day: quality journalism, a professional publication in your field, or a book slightly above your comfort level.

The online lessons and the class both use American English (*analyze, organization, sidewalk, apartment*). If you learned British English (*analyse, organisation, pavement, flat*), that is fine too. Both are correct; the important thing at C1 is to **choose one and use it consistently** in a piece of writing.



Scan me 

Translation help and more practice

This free page shows you how to **translate** a lesson into your language, and it lists free tools for listening, pronunciation, and speaking practice.

`rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html`



Scan me 

At C1, work in **English first** and use translation only to check a subtle distinction. For listening practice, choose lectures, podcasts, and panel discussions in your field, with **English** subtitles or none at all.

My teacher

Name: _____

 Phone / text: _____

 Email: _____

Other help: _____

 Can't come to class? Send a short message: "Hi, this is _____. I'm afraid I won't be able to make it today because _____. I'll catch up on the online lesson at home before the next class."

YOU'RE READY FOR THIS

At B2 you learned to argue, persuade, and adapt. Over the next 13 weeks you'll learn to be **precise**: to place an event exactly in time, to calibrate how certain you sound, to structure an argument that stands up to a critical reader, and to shift register on purpose. The gains at this level can feel quiet, but they are exactly what makes people listen. By the end, you'll write a position paper and defend it in front of the class, **in English**. We're glad you're here. Welcome.

